

13. Strategies & Supports

Terms for documenting what supports were tried and how the child responded.

Document not just what the child did, but what you tried and what made a difference. This is essential information for referrals, family conversations, and team planning.

Environmental Modifications		
reduced visual clutter in work area	offered preferential seating near the adult	provided a quiet workspace
used flexible seating (wobble cushion, floor space)	used natural lighting when possible	reduced background noise during instruction
offered a visual schedule for the routine	posted visual supports at child's eye level	used a first-then visual board
provided a designated calm-down space	offered a transition object	used sensory tools in the environment (fidget, weighted blanket)

Instructional Supports		
broke task into smaller steps	provided a visual model before asking child to try	offered a step-by-step picture guide
used hand-over-hand support	provided wait time before expecting a response	gave one direction at a time
used simple, direct language	repeated directions using the same words	offered choice within the activity
used a timer to signal transitions	provided a 5-minute and 2-minute warning before transitions	used a peer buddy model
incorporated the child's interests into the task		

Relational & Co-Regulation Supports		
adult sat beside child during difficult moment	adult used a calm, quiet voice	adult named the child's feeling aloud
adult offered two choices	adult used a warm and predictable greeting	adult reduced demands during distress
adult provided physical reassurance (if welcomed)	adult used humor to de-escalate	adult narrated the plan ('First we will...')
adult provided genuine specific praise		

Movement & Sensory Supports		
offered a movement break before the task	incorporated movement into the learning activity	provided a sensory bin as a calming option
offered deep pressure activities before demanding tasks	used weighted lap pad	offered resistance band on chair legs
provided proprioceptive input through obstacle course	offered headphones or earmuffs during loud activities	allowed child to use gloves or tools with messy materials
offered alternatives to messy materials		